

Gotabgaa Australia

GST Registration & PayID Readiness Guide

Version 1.0 · June 2026 · For leadership, treasurer & finance volunteers

Important: This document is general guidance for Australian community associations. It is **not legal or tax advice**. Confirm your obligations with a qualified accountant or tax agent based on your legal structure (incorporated association, ACNC charity, company, etc.).

1. Purpose

This guide explains what Gotabgaa Australia needs **after registering for GST** (or while preparing to register) before integrating **PayID** and bank transfer (EFT) for membership fees and event bookings on the website.

GST registration and **PayID** are separate steps:

- **GST** — how you report tax to the ATO
- **PayID** — how money arrives in your association bank account

PayID does **not** calculate or deduct GST. Your invoices, bookkeeping, and BAS (Business Activity Statement) do.

Related document: *Membership Payments & Tax Guide* (same docs folder).

2. What is a “GST account”? (Clarification)

In Australia you do **not** receive a separate “GST account number” from the ATO. When people say “GST account” they usually mean one or more of the following:

1. **GST registration** linked to your ABN
2. Your association’s **business bank account** (where PayID payments land)
3. **Internal bookkeeping** to track GST collected and owed

For PayID integration you need all three set up correctly — but only one actual bank account.

3. What you get from GST registration (ATO / ABN)

After registering for GST, record and use these details on invoices, receipts, and the website:

Item	Why you need it
Legal entity name	Exact spelling on tax invoices and receipts (e.g. Gotabgaa Australia Inc.)
ABN	Required on tax invoices; can also be used as your PayID
GST registration start date	When you must start charging or showing GST correctly
Accounting basis	Cash or Accrual — affects when GST is reported on your BAS
BAS lodgement cycle	Usually quarterly (sometimes monthly or annual)
GST reporting method	Usually Simpler BAS or full GST reporting
Registered business address	For invoices and ATO records
Contact email / phone	For member receipts and finance queries

4. What you need from your bank (for PayID)

Set up on the **association’s bank account** — not a personal account:

Bank detail	Purpose
Account name	Must match your legal entity name
BSB + account number	Backup payment method if a member pays by EFT instead of PayID
PayID	Instant payments — commonly your ABN or official association email
Business / community account	Correct account type for an incorporated association or NFP

Money goes **directly** to your association account. No Stripe, PayPal, or third-party processor is required for Phase 1.

5. Questions for your accountant (before going live)

Confirm these before showing GST amounts on the website:

1. Should Gotabgaa Australia register for GST? (Turnover of \$75k+ generally requires registration.)
2. Are **membership fees** GST-taxable for our structure?
3. Are **event ticket / booking fees** GST-taxable?
4. Are **donations** treated separately from membership fees?
5. Should prices be **GST-inclusive** or **GST-exclusive**?
 - Example inclusive: \$55 total (\$50 + \$5 GST)
 - Example exclusive: \$50 + \$5 GST = \$55 total
6. Do we need formal **tax invoices** for every payment?
7. Are we ACNC registered / income tax exempt? (This does not automatically answer GST treatment.)

6. What to show on every receipt / tax invoice

Once GST-registered (or if your accountant confirms GST-free supplies), each receipt should include:

- ☐ Association **legal name**
- ☐ **ABN**
- ☐ **"Tax invoice"** wording (when required)
- ☐ Unique **invoice / receipt number** (e.g. GAA-INV-2026-0042)
- ☐ **Date** of issue
- ☐ Member or payer **name and email**
- ☐ **Description** (e.g. "Annual membership 2026" or "Event booking — Cultural Fete")
- ☐ **Amount** (and GST component if applicable)
- ☐ **Total** amount paid
- ☐ GST note: "GST included", "GST free", or "No GST has been charged"
- ☐ **Payment method** (PayID / EFT / BPAY)
- ☐ **Payment reference** used by the member (e.g. GAA-MEM-B722PUFW)

7. Internal bookkeeping (GST tracking)

You do not need a second bank account for GST, but you **should** track GST in your records:

Ledger	Purpose
Membership income	Fees received from <code>join.html</code> registrations
Event income	Ticket and booking fees from <code>book.html</code>
GST collected	10% set aside for the ATO (liability account)
Bank fees	Usually minimal for PayID / EFT
Expenses	With GST credits if GST-registered

For each PayID payment, record:

- ☐ Gross amount received
- ☐ GST portion (if taxable supply)
- ☐ Net income portion
- ☐ Member or booking reference
- ☐ Date received in bank
- ☐ Who confirmed payment in admin
- ☐ Receipt / invoice number issued

This supports your **BAS**: GST collected on sales minus GST credits on expenses = net GST owed to the ATO.

8. Payment reference format

Unique references help the treasurer match bank deposits to registrations:

Type	Example format
Membership	<code>GAA-MEM-{registration-id}</code>
Event booking	<code>GAA-EVT-{booking-id}</code>
Alternative	<code>GAA-SURNAME-2026</code>

Members **must** include the reference when paying via PayID or EFT.

9. Member payment flow (Phase 1 — PayID + EFT)

Member registers on `join.html` or `book.html`

- Confirmation shows fee + PayID + BSB/account + unique reference
- Member pays from their banking app
- Treasurer sees deposit in association account
- Admin marks registration / booking as Paid
- Receipt sent to member

Website status

- **Live:** Join portal, adjustable fee, pending status, admin view, CSV export
- **Planned:** PayID / BSB in CMS, auto reference, Mark as paid, ABN on receipts

10. Pre-launch checklist

- ☐ ABN active and correct on all documents
- ☐ GST registered (if required or chosen by leadership)
- ☐ Accountant confirmed GST treatment for membership and events
- ☐ Association business bank account opened (not personal)
- ☐ PayID enabled and linked (ABN or official email recommended)
- ☐ BSB + account number ready for EFT backup
- ☐ Invoice / receipt template agreed with accountant
- ☐ Payment reference format documented (`GAA-MEM-*` , `GAA-EVT-*`)
- ☐ Treasurer process: match reference → mark paid → send receipt
- ☐ BAS lodgement dates in calendar (usually quarterly)
- ☐ Two-signatory rule for payments above policy threshold
- ☐ Bank details published only on official website pages

11. What to provide for website PayID integration

When leadership is ready to add PayID to the website, provide:

1. Legal entity name
2. ABN
3. PayID (ABN, email, or phone as registered with your bank)

4. BSB and account number
5. Membership fee amount(s)
6. Event fee amounts (if applicable)
7. GST wording from accountant (included / free / not applicable)
8. Payment reference prefix (`GAA-MEM` , `GAA-EVT` , etc.)
9. Receipt contact email

12. Security & governance reminders

- Never use a personal bank account for association fees
- Publish bank details only on official Gotabgaa Australia website pages
- Keep a ledger: ID, name, amount, date, method, who confirmed
- Reconcile bank statement monthly against admin CSV export
- Separate membership fees from donations in records where required

13. Related documents (local folder)

- `Gotabgaa-Australia-Membership-Payments-and-Tax-Guide.pdf`
- `Gotabgaa-Australia-Governance-Structure.pdf`
- `Gotabgaa-Australia-National-Structure.pdf`